enormous span of years they changed their courses sometimes, and even appeared to shrivel up, yet they preserved their essential identity. T h e y could not have done so if they had not possessed a sound instinct for life. T h a t staying power need not necessarily be a virtue; it may well mean, as I think it has meant in India for a long time past, stagnation and decay. But it is a major fact to be reckoned with, especially in these days when we seem to be witnessing an undermining, in repeated wars a n d crises, of a proud and advanced civilization. O u t of this crucible of war, wherein so much is melting, we hope that something finer will emerge for the west as well as the east, something t h a t will retain all the great achievements of humanity and a d d to them what they lacked. But this repeated and widespread destruction not only of material resources and h u m a n lives, b u t of essential values that have given meaning to life, is significant. Was it that in spite of astonishing progress in numerous directions and the higher standards, undreamed of in previous ages, that came in its train, our modern highly industrialized civilization did not possess some essential ingredient, and that the seeds of self-destruction lay within it?